Are you asking for **less than you deserve?**

It’s not just you.

Many nonprofit leaders are taking a “scarcity vow” without realizing it.

A “scarcity vow” is when leaders quietly accept less to keep their work going.

Here’s what you need to know about this trend and how to overcome it.

Women and leaders of color face more financial challenges.

Women ask for raises and promotions as often or more than men, but are 25% less likely to get them.

Nonprofits led by people of color have, on average, 24% smaller budgets.

49% of nonprofit leaders of color say low pay is a challenge.

After years of asking but not getting, the "vow" takes hold.

Nonprofit leaders learn to live with less, for themselves and their orgs.

They think they are being realistic and a team player, but it hurts them and their work long-term.

Nearly 90% of nonprofit leaders are concerned about burning out.

What leaders can do: Start noticing your patterns.

Ask yourself:

- Did I lower my grant ask because it felt safer or because that's what I need?
- Did I cut a position just to look good in front of my board?
- When did I last ask for what the work actually costs?

But real change requires the sector to step up.

Board members: Ask the leader what they cut from the budget before bringing it to you. And find out what they could accomplish if they had 30% more revenue.

Funders: Provide nonprofits with long-term, unrestricted grants and make sure to fund salaries.

Learn more about the scarcity vow, the challenges nonprofits face, and how the sector can help stop this trend.

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